

HR Policy Handbook

Kestrel Systems Pvt. Ltd. | Document ID: KSPL-HR-POL-004 | Version 4.1 | Effective: 1 April 2026
| Owner: HR Policy Team

This handbook applies to all permanent employees. Financial benefits referenced here are defined in the Travel, Expense & Relocation Policy (KSPL-FIN-POL-003). IT equipment and access rules are defined in the IT Services & Information Security Policy (KSPL-IT-POL-002).

1. Purpose and Scope

- 1.1** This handbook applies to all permanent employees of Kestrel Systems Pvt. Ltd. working from the Pune (headquarters), Mumbai and Bengaluru offices.
- 1.2** Contract staff and interns are covered by the terms of their individual contracts and are not covered by this handbook unless stated.
- 1.3** Where this handbook refers to another company policy for a topic, the referenced policy governs that topic.
- 1.4** Employee grades: G1 to G3 are Associate levels, G4 to G5 are Manager levels, and G6 to G7 are Senior Leadership levels.

2. Working Hours and Hybrid Work

- 2.1** The standard work week is Monday to Friday, 40 hours. Core hours, when every employee must be available, are 11:00 to 16:00 IST.
- 2.2** Hybrid work: employees must work from their assigned office for a minimum of 3 days per week.
- 2.3** Working from another city in India: employees may work from another city in India for up to 20 working days per calendar year with reporting manager approval, requested on the HR portal at least 5 working days in advance. More than 20 working days in a calendar year requires additional approval from the HR Business Partner.
- 2.4** Working from outside India is not part of the hybrid allowance. It requires written approval from both the HR Business Partner and IT Security (see IT Policy Section 4.4) and is limited to 15 working days per calendar year.
- 2.5** Employees working away from the office must connect to company systems only through the company VPN, as described in IT Policy Section 4.

3. Leave

- 3.1** Leave entitlements per calendar year:

Leave type	Entitlement	Key rules
Casual leave	8 days	Cannot be carried forward. Maximum 3 consecutive days.
Sick leave	10 days	Medical certificate required for more than 2 consecutive days. Cannot be carried forward.
Earned leave (EL)	18 days (accrues 1.5 days per month)	Unused EL can be carried forward up to a maximum balance of 30 days. At exit, up to 30 days of EL are encashed.
Maternity leave	26 weeks paid	For the first two children; 12 weeks for subsequent children.
Paternity leave	10 working days	To be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption.
Bereavement leave	5 working days	For the death of an immediate family member.
Relocation leave	3 working days	Only for approved internal transfers (Section 4).

- 3.2** Probation: during the first 6 months, earned leave accrues but can be taken only after confirmation. Casual and sick leave are available from the joining date on a pro-rata basis.
- 3.3** Leave during notice period: earned leave cannot be taken during the notice period except with written approval of the HR Head. Unused earned leave is encashed as per Section 3.1.
- 3.4** Unpaid leave: up to 30 working days per calendar year may be approved by the HR Business Partner, only after all earned leave has been used.

3.5 All leave is applied for on the HR portal. Planned leave of more than 3 days must be applied for at least 2 weeks in advance.

4. Internal Transfer and Relocation

4.1 Eligibility: an employee must have completed at least 12 months of continuous service on the transfer date. A transfer may be initiated by the company, or requested by the employee and approved by both the current and the receiving department heads.

4.2 Process: the employee submits Form HR-12 (Relocation Request) on the HR portal at least 30 days before the planned move date. HR confirms the transfer within 7 working days.

4.3 Benefits: the employee receives 3 paid working days of relocation leave. Financial benefits, including the relocation allowance, travel to the new location and household goods shifting, are defined in the Travel, Expense & Relocation Policy, Section 6.

4.4 Temporary accommodation: on arrival at the new location, the employee may stay in a company-arranged guest house or hotel for up to 15 nights.

4.5 IT equipment during relocation is handled as per IT Policy Section 6.

4.6 An employee who resigns within 12 months of relocating may have to repay part of the relocation allowance, as per the Travel, Expense & Relocation Policy, Section 6.6.

5. Onboarding

5.1 New joiners must submit the following on or before the first working day:

- PAN card and Aadhaar card
- Cancelled cheque or bank statement showing account details
- Highest education certificates
- Relieving letter from the previous employer
- Two passport-size photographs

5.2 HR raises the account and laptop request to IT at least 5 working days before the joining date (see IT Policy Section 3.1).

5.3 Induction runs on the first two working days. Every new joiner must acknowledge this handbook on the HR portal within 7 days of joining.

5.4 Probation lasts 6 months. HR issues a confirmation letter on successful completion.

6. Resignation and Exit

6.1 Notice periods after confirmation:

Grade	Notice period
G1 to G3	30 days
G4 to G5	60 days
G6 to G7	90 days
Any grade during probation	15 days

6.2 Notice buyout: with manager approval, an employee may buy out the unserved notice period by paying basic salary for the unserved days. The company may also waive notice.

6.3 Exit clearance: the employee returns the laptop, access card and all other company assets on the last working day (see IT Policy Section 8).

6.4 Full and final settlement is processed as per the Travel, Expense & Relocation Policy, Section 8.

6.5 The experience letter is issued within 7 days of the full and final settlement.

7. Conduct, Grievances and Contacts

7.1 All employees must follow the Code of Conduct, acknowledged at joining.

7.2 Grievances can be raised with the reporting manager or by email to hr-help@kestrel.example. HR responds within 5 working days.

7.3 Complaints under the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) policy go to the Internal Committee at ic@kestrel.example.

7.4 HR portal: hr.kestrel.example. Topics not covered in this handbook should be raised with the HR Business Partner.